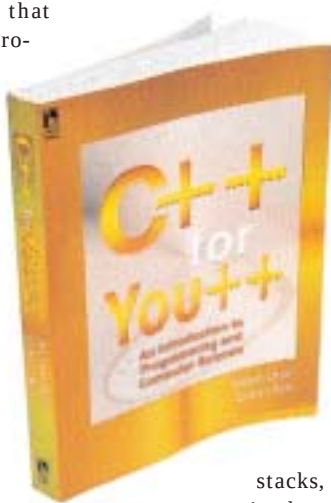




C++ for You++

Enchiridion of C++ Programming

There are way too many books that offer an introduction to C++ programming. What sets *C++ for You++* apart is that it doesn't give long essays describing simple concepts, or bamboozle you with advanced explanations. In this dichotomous book, the first section contains the explanation of C++ programming, and the second explains implementation details, such as classes and data structures. The book starts off with an introduction to computers in general, touching upon both hardware and software briefly. The second chapter introduces a C++ program containing all the basic elements such as Pre-processor, loops, library functions, etc. This lets you to get a feel of C++ right from



the beginning. From here, all the concepts are explained in detail, in separate chapters. There is an exercise with answers provided at the end of each chapter. The second section starts with a chapters on linked list, stacks, queues, etc and moves in that direction. Towards the end the authors deal with algorithms, starting with the analysis of algorithms

and finishing off with chapters on searching, hashing and sorting. A sore point of the book is the numbering of the pages. Each page is numbered as XXX-DD, where XXX is the abbreviation of the chapter name and DD gives the page number within that chapter—making it difficult to reach to a specific page directly.

The book is definitely not recommended for those who are already fluent in C and want to learn C++. Concepts such as Object oriented programming and related concepts are treated very lightly in the Chapter 22. Also, the book places more emphasis on practical implementation rather than the theoretical aspects of programming. The book is aimed at those who want to start off by learning C++, and the book serves this purpose pretty well.

Publisher: Vikas Publishing House Pvt Ltd ■ **Author:** Maria Litvin, Gary Litvin ■ **Distributor:** Vikas Publishing House Pvt Ltd
Phone: 91-11-24314605 ■ **Fax:** 91-11-24310879 ■ **E-mail:** orders@gobookshopping.com ■ **Price:** Rs 295
Rating: ★★★★★



Command & Conquer Generals

Stop clickin' around, general!

Developed by Westwood studios, *Generals* is a massive effort to resurrect the dying Command & Conquer series. The game is easily the best one in this particular series.

Units have been modelled neatly, and their motion is fluid. From minute touches, such as track marks, to intricate explosions, the effects are simply marvelous. All the units have a distinct voice-over, and a unique weapon attack effect.

All the factions have different units that use a totally different strategy and attacking style. Use a set of small strikes targeted at specific units and structures.

A new feature is the very obvious Gen-



Amazing explosion effects are quite common in this game

erals system, which can be used to upgrade units, buildings and strategies.

The campaign missions are loosely based on the erratic story. This results in a

progressively challenging game with specific objectives.

Generals uses the left mouse button for all commands, unlike other strategy games, which use both left and right mouse buttons—this takes some getting used to. However, unlike previous versions, this one has the control interface on a bottom bar. Also, a change in the battle dynamics has been introduced by including the 'Fog Of War', to hide areas where your units are not stationed.

The game has sparkling 3D visuals, and the sound effects are a real treat. To sum up, *Generals* is a great game to play that offers immense replay value.

Genre: RTS ■ **Developer:** Westwood Studios ■ **Publisher:** EA Games ■ **Distributor:** Gayatri Impex ■ **System requirements:** 800 MHz CPU, 128 MB RAM, 1.8 GB hard disk space, 32 MB GeForce2 video card, DirectX 8.1 ■ **Price:** Rs1,499 ■ **Phone:** 022-23870260 ■ **Fax:** 022-23863367
E-mail: sales@gamemasti.com ■ **Web site:** www.gayatriimpex.com
Rating: ★★★★★